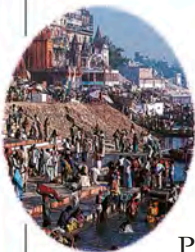




THE INDIAN SUBCONTINENT



Bound by the Himalayas in the north and the Indian Ocean in the south, the Indian subcontinent is a region that includes the nations of India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Nepal, and the Maldives. Most of these countries are young, having formed after the end of European colonial rule in the 20th century. Hinduism, Islam, and Buddhism are the most common religions practiced in the subcontinent.



Railroad network

Stretching over an amazing 41,861 miles (67,368 km), the railroad network in India is one of the largest in the world. Most people in India prefer to use trains to travel between towns and cities. Trains are run by the government-owned organization called Indian Railways, which employs more than 1.4 million people and is one of the largest employers in the world.

Urban life

A booming economy underlines India's rapid growth into one of the world's fastest developing nations.

Almost a third of India's population now lives in urban areas, mainly in big metropolitan cities such as New Delhi and Mumbai. Skyscrapers frame parts of the skyline of Mumbai, which has a population of more than 22 million.

